SOUNDLINE

Two hours of practice. Four hours of making. Every adult knows your kid.

Soundline is a school on the Sound for grades six through eight, opening next September in Miller Place — and it adds a grade a year through twelfth.

Depth with direction.

soundlineschool.com
hello@soundlineschool.com

WHY FAMILIES ARE LOOKING

Middle school is three years. They go fast.

Your child might be doing fine on paper and quietly checked out. Or bored, waiting for everyone else to catch up. Or working hard, and nobody's noticed. Or stuck on something, and moved along to the next grade anyway.

Here, nobody moves on until they've got it, and nobody waits once they have. Every student gets real work, a reason to finish it, and adults who know them by name. That's what Soundline is built to do.

A DAY HERE

Students do real work, finish it, and show it to someone.

8:30 — 3:00 — 5:30

Practice
Two hours · math, reading, writing

Making
Four hours · seminar, lab, studio, the quest

Extended Day
3:00 to 5:30, if you need it

Mornings are practice.

Math, reading, and writing at each student's own pace, with a guide in the room. Nobody waits for the class to catch up, and nobody gets left behind it. Two hours, done well, and done.

Afternoons are for making.

History, literature, and science are taught by a person with a book, never by an app. Studio runs in six-week projects with a real audience: a video game, a robot, a sculpture, a short documentary, a zine the school press publishes, a song the ensemble performs.

Big work gets defended out loud.

No slides, no screen. A student, their work, and good questions.

A WEEK AT SOUNDLINE

Same rhythm every week, so the work can be different.

MONDAY	**Launch**	8:45. One question, one goal, one plan for the week.
TUESDAY	**Lab, then studio**	Ninety minutes, hands on, written up before studio. Then everyone makes something: a video game, a robot, a portrait, a sculpture, a song for the ensemble.
WEDNESDAY	**Seminar**	A novel, a question, a paragraph. Every seminar ends in writing.
THURSDAY	**Apprenticeships**	Grades 7 and 8 work alongside someone who does it for a living. Younger students build their quest.
FRIDAY	**All In, then Showcase**	The whole school takes on one thing together. A song, a mural, a project for someone in town. At 2:00, someone presents and something is performed. Usually loud. Families welcome.

TWO WAYS IN

THE SCHOOL · FIVE DAYS

For families ready to make the move.

Monday to Friday, 8:30 to 3:00, with Extended Day until 5:30. Enroll, and that's it. No homeschool paperwork.

THE COLLABORATIVE · THREE DAYS

For homeschooling families.

Monday, Wednesday, and Friday. Same guides, same rooms, same studio. You keep your homeschool plan, and we hand you the course descriptions and hours logs to go with it.

OUR VISION

By eighth grade, a student who can:

01
Learn something hard.
And prove it, one skill at a time.

02
Make something new.
For a real client in town, on a real deadline.

03
Think it through.
In writing, before anyone else weighs in.

04
Say it out loud.
And defend it, with no screen to hide behind.

05
Show up for their town.
One project every year is for the community.

06
Know where they're headed.
And look back on how they got there.

New York just decided a diploma should mean six things, not a set of test scores. We built the school on those six.

Every six weeks, your child adds to a folder of proof: what they made, what they defended, how much they grew. By eighth grade it's a portfolio. Along the way, it's the best answer to "what did you do at school?"

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT'S WORKING

Measured, published, and shown.

We measure growth three times a year and publish it.

Every student takes the NWEA MAP assessment in fall, winter, and spring. We publish how much the whole school grew, counting everyone, including students who leave. No child's score is ever public. Your child's comes home to you.

You'll see the work.

The documentary, the robot, the performance, and your child standing up to explain it.

AI is a subject here.

Students learn to use it well, on purpose. It is never a shortcut in seminar, lab, or the defense.

We answer to New York.

New York doesn't license private schools. You register with the state, and the district reviews that what you teach is equivalent. We do all of it, then start accreditation once we're open.

WHY IT WORKS

None of this is new. Putting it in one building is.

MORNINGS

You don't move on until you've got it.

Schools that make students master a skill before moving on beat schools that follow the calendar. More than a hundred controlled studies agree, and the students who were struggling gain the most.

AFTERNOONS

Real projects raise real scores.

In recent randomized trials, students taught through long projects outscored classmates taught the usual way on state tests and national exams.

SEMINAR

Writing it down is how it sticks.

Students who write about what they're learning in science, history, and math learn more of it. So does anyone who has to explain their work out loud.

ADVISORY

Being known changes how hard a student works.

A close relationship with a teacher is one of the strongest predictors of how engaged a student is, and it matters more as they get older. That's why every student keeps one advisor for three years.

The studies, with sources: soundlineschool.com/research.html

WHY SOUNDLINE

Every child has a soundline.

Before sonar, sailors dropped a sounding line over the side: a rope marked in fathoms, weighted with lead. A dab of tallow in the weight brought up a piece of the bottom (sand, shell, mud), so they knew what was underneath, too. Only then did they set a course.

That's how we come to know your child. Not only where they are, skill by skill, but what sparks them and how deep it runs. Middle schoolers thrive when they feel seen, when the adult mentoring them truly knows what they need.

Then we set a direction together. What sparks your child becomes part of the actual work, approached with intention: the next skill, the next project, the next thing worth showing their peers and their town. That gives a student more than a written grade ever could.

We teach everything New York expects. Your child's soundline is what we build on.

Eight to ten in a grade. Nobody's stuck in it.

Students work by skill across the school, and on Fridays the whole school builds one thing together. Small enough there's nowhere to hide, big enough for a real seminar.

One advisor, three years.

Every student has the same guide as their advisor from the day they start, in a group of eight to ten.

Grouped by skill, not age.

A sixth grader and an eighth grader can work the same skill at the same table. Each moves on when it's mastered.

Three grades, one building.

And a grade added every year through twelfth. The older students are out in town on apprenticeships.

ABOUT US

Who's building it.

FOUNDER

Nicole Galante

An educator who has spent over twenty years helping teachers and schools get better. She led the statewide team that wrote New York's framework and handbook for virtual schools.

LEAD GUIDE

Adam King

A musician and teacher. He designs and runs music and STEAM programs for libraries across Long Island (escape rooms, instrument labs, world percussion) and teaches private lessons. He'll know your child by Wednesday.

OPERATIONS

Gina Dimichino

For more than thirty-five years she has taught dance to North Shore kids, many of them right at this age, and she has run businesses here her whole life, including her own salon. She makes sure every family feels seen, and handles every detail in between.

ACADEMIC SYSTEMS

Izzy Galante

Designs how the school teaches: the sequence, the mastery gates, and how we know it worked. Co-wrote New York's framework and handbook for virtual schools. Teaches a live seminar every week.

QUESTIONS FAMILIES ASK

How many students will there be?

Eight to ten in a grade — and nobody's stuck in their grade. Students work by skill across the school, and on Fridays the whole school builds one thing together. Small enough there's nowhere to hide, big enough for a real seminar.

Isn't that too small?

It's three grades in one building, and it adds a grade every year through twelfth. Your child's working group changes by subject, the whole school is together on Fridays, and the older students are out in town on apprenticeships. And every adult in the building knows your child by name.

What does it cost?

We share tuition at the first information night, November 12, before anyone is asked to commit. It's paid monthly over twelve months, and founding families get a rate that stays locked for as long as their child is enrolled.

What about high school?

We add ninth grade in our second year, then a grade every year through twelfth. New York has moved to a diploma built on evidence of six things a graduate can do, and every one of them is something your child makes, defends, or shows here, every six weeks. That folder of work goes with them wherever they go next.

Is Soundline approved by New York?

New York doesn't license private schools. You register with the state, and the district reviews that what you teach is equivalent. We do all of it, then start accreditation once we're open.

We homeschool. Can we join?

Yes. The Collaborative is three days a week, Monday, Wednesday, and Friday, with the same guides, rooms, and studio. You keep your homeschool plan, and we hand you the course descriptions and hours logs to go with it.

Will our district bus my child?

Most likely. New York districts provide transportation to private schools up to fifteen miles away. You request it from your own district by April 1, and we'll send you the request already filled in.

My child has an IEP. What happens to services?

Your child can still receive services from the public school district. You request them from the district where the school is located by June 1, and we'll help you do it.

Can my child still play school sports?

New York requires students to be enrolled in the district to play on district teams, so town and club teams are the way to go — and they're where most students this age already play. We have PE in the day, and Extended Day runs until 5:30.

How much screen time is there?

Some, on purpose. Morning practice can use adaptive programs, always with a guide in the room. Seminar, lab, and the defense happen without screens. AI is taught as a subject, never used as a shortcut.

Where will the school be?

In Miller Place. We announce the building the day the lease is signed.

JOIN

Be one of our Founding Families.

Three grades under one roof, grouped by skill, not age — and we're taking founding families now.

A rate that stays locked for as long as your child is enrolled. A seat on the Family Council. A say in what Soundline becomes.

1

Take the survey.

A few minutes. Your answers shape the school, and you hear from us first. soundlineschool.com

2

Come to an information night.

Meet the guides, see a day, ask anything. November 12, December 12, and January 14.

3

Reserve a founding seat.

Founding enrollment opens at the first information night, November 12.

Prefer to talk? Write to hello@soundlineschool.com and we'll find a time.